

Myo-reps Part 3 - Progression for Maximum Muscle Growth and Development

[Myo-reps Part 3 - Progression](#)

By [Børge Fagerli](#) This is the google translated version, with changes made by me only when google couldn't find the right words (not that I can read Norwegian, but because I can understand physiology and make a good guess at what Borge meant). Any mistakes in translation or understanding are entirely mine.

You can find the original page in Norwegian [here http://myrevolution.no/myo-reps-del-3-progresjon/](http://myrevolution.no/myo-reps-del-3-progresjon/) It does not matter about the ideal [training split](#), exercise selection, technique, or the amount of exercise you have, if you do not regularly increase the weights you lift!

Everything you do must be seen against the background of; that one year from now you should lift heavier weights with the same or more reps than you do today.

We have been through the theoretical background and practical implementation of [part 1](#), we have undergone training volume and how it can be regulated through fatigue point in [part 2](#), and we will now see the progression model I recommend for the Myo-reps method.

I start most people who have not trained using Myo-reps before, even advanced lifters, with only 60% of 1RM, this corresponds to 20-25% lighter weight than your 10RM, and you will manage about 20-25 reps before you reach exhaustion.

Preferably train each muscle group 3, up to 4 times a week at the lightest weights (studies have used training frequencies of up to 6 days a week, 2 times a day!), Which is then reduced to 2 to 3 times a week when you lift heavier weights from week 5 and beyond.

The most relevant options are then to run a helkroppsprogram 3-4 times per week [George: weekly undulating periodisation?], or a 2-split over 5-6 days in weeks 1-4, and then cut down to a 2-split 3-4 days a week or with a 3-split if you have the capacity to train 5-6 days a week.

Remember that you must consider rest for the whole body and central nervous system ([CNS](#)), and not only every single muscle group, so unless you have the luxury that you can sleep, eat and exercise, I recommend that you limit yourself to a 2-split over 4 days a week (5 days in weeks 1-4) or a 3-split over 4-5 days a week. I had set up a long list of suggestions for possible training programmes based on this, but soon found out that it was so comprehensive when one should take into account the various objectives and priorities that it deserves a whole separate article, so more on that later.

I give reps for activation set (before the + sign in the notation for Myo-reps), and progress can then look like this:

Week 1: 60% 20-25 reps

Week 2: 65% 15-20 reps

Week 3: 70% 12-15 reps

Etc.

After a 3 week training phase as outlined above you could begin in the 15-20 or 12-15 rep range in the next training phase.

Høyrepstrening [George: high rep training?] will mean you will be able to recover both the tendons and joints from heavy loads and yet enjoy a muscular exercise works that will challenge the pain threshold of the toughest of the tough (no, I do not mean myself).

As studies of [Wernbom](#) shows, you can expect a dramatic [training effect](#) [George: from doing higher reps at the start], but perhaps more importantly a "priming" effect that provides a basis for better results on the lower rep training phase. Some of the volume increase that is realized is called popular sarcoplasmic hypertrophy - muscle energy substrate and supply. Increased capillarisation, glycogen stores, creatine uptake (allows more creatine phosphate), mitochondrial function and number, buffer potential, more satellite cells and much more, for those interested in the technical part of it.

A fixed progression of 5% from week to week can be difficult to achieve in practice when using light weights, as such increases for most fitness centers run at least 1 kg and up to 2 to 2.5 kg. To increase from 10kg to 12.5 kg is actually 25% increase in load, and corresponds to what would increase from 100kg to 125kg if we scale it up to heavy weights. If you do not have available 0.5-1kg of light dumbbells / weights you can use the

same weight several training sessions in a row but also follow a progression in reps (add 1-2 extra reps on the activation set), with a load progress approximately every other week. You can also use clever [wrist weights](#) of 1-3kg which attaches with velcro or straps, and are available in most sports shops.

This sounds like it will take forever, but consider: if you increase the load by only 2.5 kg per week you will lift 130kg more in one year!

Is it realistic to increase from 20kg to 150kg on [biceps curl](#) next year?

If you really think it is, I say Good Luck.

If you increase 5kg per week will be increased by 260kg a year, and this is even less likely.

So now you understand it is thus both more realistic and productive to stretch out the progress over time. Then your strength increases are approximately proportional to the increase in the weight, instead of you maxing out after a short time. This can be achieved by repeating the same load and increase the number of reps within a given time frame before increasing the weights, or by a stepwise progression in which you increase the weights for 3-6 weeks, back down 1 week, increase over 3-6 weeks, and so on. Myo-reps model of progression

Instead of following a fixed and invariable progression, it might be better to follow a more dynamic model adapted to your own progress. This I see as a natural part of Myo-reps, where one already uses a fatigue point (see [part 2](#)) to adjust the amount of exercise to suit individual requirements and recovery capability. Let us say that the objective is 3x 9-12 reps. If you only manage 8 reps on the first activation set before approaching exhaustion, use the same weight next time. If you manage 13 reps it's too easy, and you can increase the weight next time. If you get to 15 reps and even know that you probably can do 5-10 reps more, then you have forgotten to put on your glasses today and probably put the wrong weights on. Consider the first set as a warmup, put on more weight and take a few minutes break before doing your Myo-reps set.

Keep the reps in a given area (12-15, 9-12 or 6-9) for 2-3 weeks with this progression method, and take a little avlastninguke (also called deloading) every 6-8 weeks. Here take down the weight 5-10% and take a light routine for the body with 2-3 "normal" sets on the base routine before starting the new training phase.

After all, it takes time to build muscle and increase in strength, so you must be able to set up both short-and long-term (realistic) goals, with embedded deloading / relief phases to aid recovery and injury prevention. Hurry slowly.

Progression after a priming phase of 3-4 weeks, might then look like this:

Week 5: 12-15 reps

Week 6: 9-12 reps

Week 7: 9-12 reps

Week 8: 6-9 reps

Week 9: 6-9 reps or avlastnings-uke/deloading with lighter weights and fewer workouts At level intermediate to advanced I would recommend a so-called non-linear progression model, where you vary the reps from training areas for training or week to week, for example:

Week 1

Day 1 - upper body: 12-15 reps

Day 2 - legs: 12-15 reps

Day 3 - upper body: 9-12 reps

Day 4 - Bone: 9-12 reps

Week 2

Day 1 - upper body: 6-9 reps (3-6 reps or heavy exercise)

Day 2 - leg: 6-9 reps (3-6 reps or heavier exercise

Day 3 - torso: 12-15 reps (repeat cycle)

Day 4 - legs: 12-15 reps

etc.

When we come to such heavy weights I.E. 4-6 reps area, we are moving more and more into neural and strength-oriented training. The weights make it difficult to get a high amount of exercise without being dangerously near the border of training and overload, so a Myo-reps program may stop here. The road ahead may now follow three main directions:

1. Start of new training phase with slightly heavier weights than the previous training phase. Variation in training and exercises split makes sense for a new and honest evaluation of your physique and goal ahead. Please avlastningsuke / deloading where you try out new exercises and variations before you get started. Let this be a motivation spike!
2. Continue progress and run a program in the 1-5 reps range to peak maximum strength. The same principles and approach as presented in this series can largely be transferred to such a program, read more in this article about auto-regulation ...
3. Take one to two weeks of total rest, preferably with deep tissue massage, flexibility and mobility training. Go on vacation. If you've been training consistently for 4-6 months, this is one of the most sensible and productive things to do for long term success! You will not lose muscle mass unless you are bedridden with zero food intake, and even then you will quickly be back to old levels when you begin to train again.

Myo-reps - The Revolution Continues ...If you think all this was difficult to understand, then continue on to section 4 which has a simpler version of a Myo-reps program, as well as proposals to divide the routine and exercises.

Try out the method and experiments with different training splits, exercises, reps areas and rest breaks - but just do not get so hung up on details that you forget the most important thing: Lift progressively heavier weights, long enough and often enough, from month to month and year to year , while still eating enough to support the development and recovery, you will be both bigger and stronger!

We also have a [discussion forum](#) for questions about Myo-reps, and offers both [web-PT and personal follow-up](#) if you want an integrated Myo-reps based exercise with diet scheme, please contact us!

With wishes for a productive Myo-reps training programme.

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Thanks for Borge for that, you can also see more of his articles on this site here (Parts [1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)). You can see some of my training programs [here](#)

And now you can get some free coaching for YOUR myo-reps journey. Just fill in the form below and we will get started!

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